WS WASHINGTON SQUARE RESEARCH PARTNERS

BROADCOM®

Sector: Technology | Semiconductors & Software

AVGO

NASDAQ | BROADCOM INC | USD

$399.83

▲ +36.3% (30D) +107.7% (12M)

The $2T AI Compounder: Why Broadcom's Moat Is Wider Than You Think

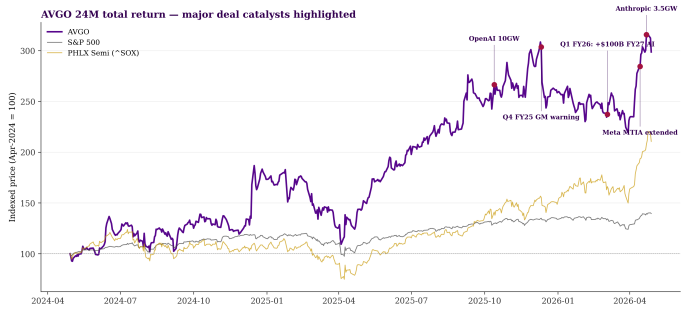
Initiating BUY | 12-month PT $475 | +19% upside

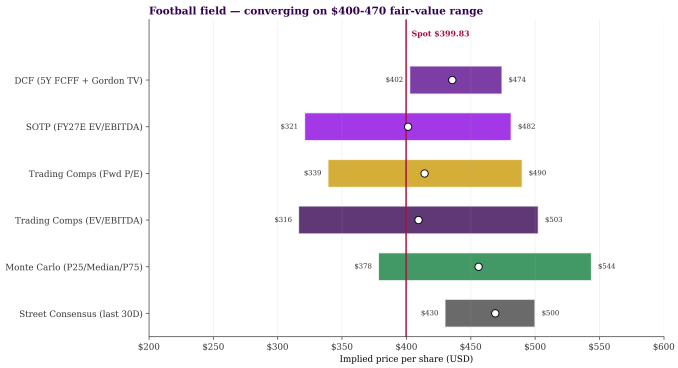
BUY

Target: $475.00

12-month horizon | Dec-2026

Implied upside +18.8%





MARKET DATA & FY25A OPERATING

Last price (29-Apr-26)	$399.83
52W range	$191 – $423
Market cap / EV	$1.99T / $2.04T
Diluted shares	4,969 mn
Beta (5Y / 2Y)	1.63 / 1.20
Revenue / EBITDA	$63.9B / $43.2B
EBITDA margin / EPS	67.7% / $6.82
FCF / NetDebt-EBITDA	$26.9B / 1.13×

VALUATION TRIANGULATION

DCF (5Y FCFF)	$436
SOTP (FY27E EV/EBITDA)	$401
Comps Fwd P/E (22×)	$414
Comps EV/EBITDA (18×)	$409
Monte Carlo median	$456
Street median (n=11)	$460
Our 12M PT*	**$475**

*Anchored on MC mean.

KEY CATALYSTS (NEXT 12M)

5-Jun-2026	Q2 FY26 earnings
H2-2026	TPU 3nm vol. ramp
H2-2026	OpenAI rack ship
4-Sep-2026	Q3 FY26 earnings
Dec-2026	Q4 + FY27 guide

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Student-prepared educational research; not investment advice. Data as of 29 April 2026.

Investment Summary

Lead author: Tanishk Yadav | Coverage initiation

Recommendation: BUY | 12-Month PT: $475 (18.8% upside)

We initiate coverage of Broadcom (AVGO) with a **BUY** rating and a December-2026 price target of $475, representing 18.8% upside to the 29-April spot price of $399.83. Our valuation triangulates a $401–$474 fair-value range across DCF, sum-of-the-parts, peer comparables, and a 10,000-path Monte Carlo simulation that places the median intrinsic price at $456 with a 68.3% probability of trading above spot at current levels.

We are constructive on the **operating story**: AI semiconductor revenue grew 106% year-over-year in Q1 FY26 to $8.4 billion, management has line-of-sight to $100 billion+ in FY27 AI chip revenue across six XPU customers, and the company has secured leading-edge wafer, HBM, and substrate capacity through FY28. Recent deal flow—OpenAI's 10GW co-design partnership (October 2025), Anthropic's 3.5GW commitment via Google Cloud (April 2026), and Meta's MTIA extension through 2029 (April 2026)—pushed Broadcom into the $2 trillion market-cap club.

We are constructive on **valuation after the recent pullback**: shares have retreated from the April highs but our Monte Carlo's $E[\text{intrinsic}] = \$471$ still exceeds spot by 18%, and the right tail is fat (P75 $544, P95 $711) reflecting realistic upside if FY27 AI revenue prints at the high end of the analyst range ($130–150B per UBS / Barclays).

Our PT of $475 sits above the Street median ($460) and reflects our view that the bear-case PTs from D.A. Davidson ($335) and Cantor Fitzgerald ($300) are unlikely to materialize given the catalyst path. We see further upside if the December 2026 FY27 guide validates the $120B+ AI revenue scale.

Snapshot	
Ticker	AVGO US
Sector	Tech
Industry	Semiconductors
CEO	Hock E. Tan
HQ	Palo Alto, CA
Fiscal year-end	1-Nov
Next print	5-Jun-26 (Q2)

Valuation footprint	
DCF (mid)	$436
SOTP (mid)	$401
Comps P/E (mid)	$414
Comps EV/EBITDA	$409
MC median	$456
MC P(>spot)	68.3%
Street median	$460

Five-Point Thesis

1. **The AI thesis is real and the multiple is defensible.** The six-customer XPU portfolio (Google, Meta, ByteDance, SoftBank/ARM, Anthropic via Google, OpenAI) gives Broadcom secular topline growth that few semiconductor peers can match. At 23× forward P/E, the multiple is in line with the peer median (25.6×).

2. **Customer concentration is a real risk but a rapidly diversifying one.** Google TPU drives ∼50% of AI revenue today—falling to 35% by FY27 as Anthropic (∼$42B), Meta MTIA (multi-GW), and OpenAI (>1GW) ramp. The portfolio effect cushions individual program risk.

3. **Margins are the upside surprise that has not yet been priced.** Management reversed its prior rack-scale margin warning, now guiding flat 77% gross margin through FY27 as the mix shifts toward higher-attach networking (40% of AI revenue in Q2). This alleviates the largest investor overhang from December 2025.

4. **Competitive moat is wider than market gives credit for.** JPMorgan's primary research suggests Broadcom maintains an 18-month design lead over Google's internal Zebrafish COT effort, and the company has won the next-gen 2nm TPU. Marvell's recent Alphabet engagement is at the early stage and unlikely to displace Broadcom share through 2028.

5. **Recommendation derived from analysis.** Six valuation methods converge: MC median $456, DCF $436, Comps P/E $414, Comps EV/EBITDA $409, SOTP $401, Street median $460. Our $475 PT sits modestly above the Street median, reflecting the catalyst path through year-end and the right-tail in our Monte Carlo distribution.

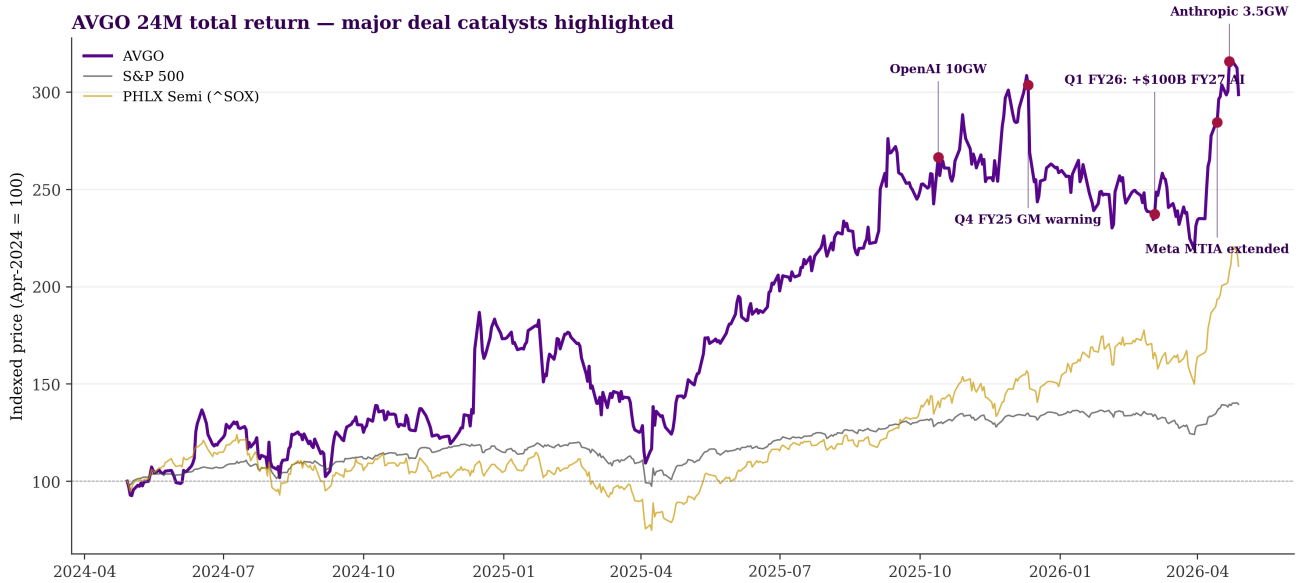

Figure 1. AVGO 24-month total return vs. S&P 500 and PHLX Semiconductor Index, with major deal catalysts annotated. Source: Yahoo Finance (yfinance), team analysis.

1. Business Description

Lead author: Ramana Sriram | Industry coverage

Broadcom Inc. designs, manufactures, and sells semiconductors and enterprise infrastructure software through two reporting segments. **Semiconductor Solutions** (65% of Q1 FY26 revenue) encompasses custom AI accelerators (XPUs), networking silicon (Tomahawk/Jericho/Trident switching ASICs, SerDes, and optical components), wireless connectivity (FBAR filters, Wi-Fi/Bluetooth combos for the iPhone), broadband (cable/fiber gateways), storage (Fibre Channel HBAs, RAID), and industrial connectivity. **Infrastructure Software** (35%) was rebuilt through the $69 billion VMware acquisition in November 2023 and now combines VMware Cloud Foundation, Symantec enterprise security, and the legacy CA mainframe business.

The company was created by the 2016 reverse merger of Avago Technologies and the original Broadcom Corporation. Under CEO Hock Tan—now in his twentieth year leading the combined entity—Broadcom has executed a serial M&A playbook: Brocade (2017), CA (2018), Symantec Enterprise (2019), and VMware (2023). The model strips overhead and re-prices subscriptions toward the largest enterprise customers. Five-year revenue CAGR is 23.5%; non-GAAP operating margin expanded from 47% in FY20 to 66.4% in Q1 FY26.

1.1 Segment economics

Segment	FY25 revenue	Gross margin	Demand driver
AI Semiconductor (XPU + networking)	$24.5B (38%)	∼60–65%	Hyperscaler capex
Non-AI Semiconductor	$15.5B (24%)	∼70–72%	End-market cyclical
Infrastructure Software	$23.9B (37%)	∼92–93%	Enterprise refresh + VCF migration

Table 1. FY25 segment composition. Source: Broadcom Q4 FY25 8-K, Mizuho 4-Mar-26.

1.2 The XPU customer roster

Management discloses that Broadcom now serves six committed XPU (custom accelerator) customers. JPMorgan and Mizuho identify them through a process of elimination as: Google (TPU, the anchor program since 2014), Meta (MTIA), ByteDance, an ARM/SoftBank-linked program (likely Stargate), Anthropic (via the Google three-way), and OpenAI (the October 2025 deal). The six-customer base, plus continued networking attach, supports management's "more than $100 billion" FY27 AI revenue line-of-sight statement on the Q1 FY26 earnings call.

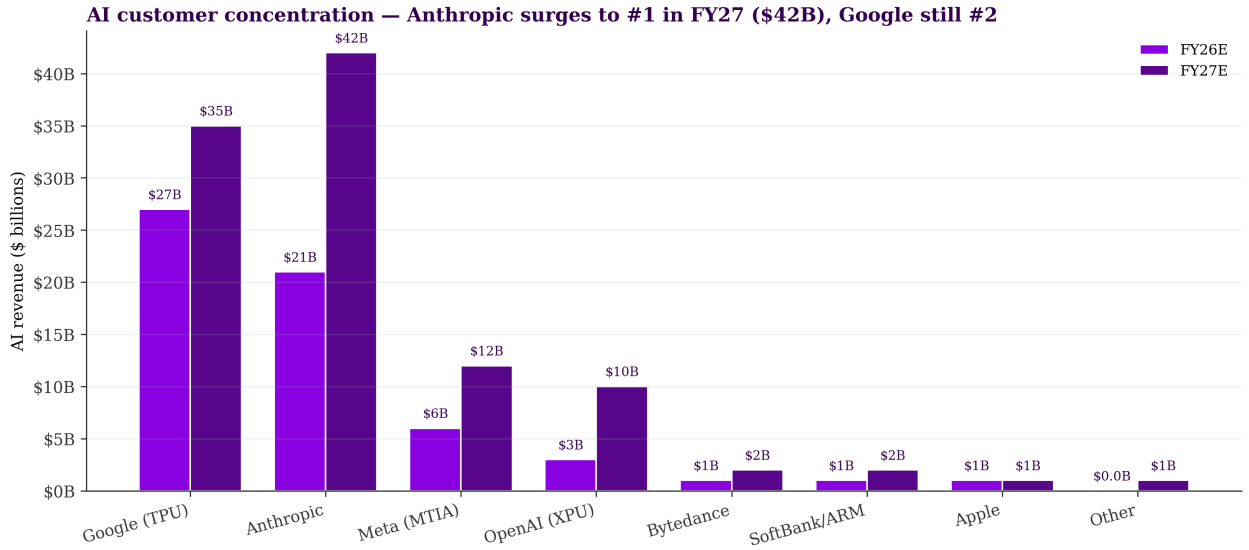

Figure 2. Customer-level AI revenue breakdown, FY26E vs. FY27E. Anthropic surges to the top spot in FY27 on the 3GW TPU rack ramp. Source: Mizuho Exhibit 1 (4-Mar-26), JPMorgan (5-Mar-26), team estimates.

2. Recent Strategic Catalysts

Lead author: Ramana Sriram | Industry coverage

The four months between Q1 FY26 earnings (4-Mar-26) and the date of this report contain the most consequential dealflow in Broadcom's history outside of the VMware close.

2.1 OpenAI: 10 GW custom XPU partnership (October 2025)

OpenAI and Broadcom signed a co-development agreement under which OpenAI designs the accelerator while Broadcom owns the manufacturing, networking, and system integration. Total deployment of 10 gigawatts spans late 2026 through end-2029. Mizuho's Vijay Rakesh estimates this is the program now identified as "Customer 6" in Broadcom disclosures and embeds $3 billion of FY26 revenue and $10 billion in FY27.

2.2 Anthropic: 3.5 GW three-way deal (April 2026)

Announced jointly by Anthropic, Google Cloud, and Broadcom, this commitment routes Anthropic's compute through Google Cloud running on Broadcom-fabricated TPU silicon. Mizuho models $21 billion of recognized AI revenue at Broadcom in 2026 stepping to $42 billion in 2027, making Anthropic the single largest contributor to Broadcom's FY27 AI mix—surpassing internal Google demand.

2.3 Meta MTIA extension through 2029 (April 2026)

Meta's custom inference chip program (MTIA, internally codenamed Athena/Iris/Olympus) was extended for multi-gigawatt deployments through 2029. Wells Fargo models the Meta program at multiple gigawatts by FY27 with a clear vector to expand vertically integrated AI infrastructure away from Nvidia GPU dependence.

2.4 Google TPU "Sunfish" 3nm ramp + Cloud Network Insights (April 2026)

Beyond chips, Broadcom announced an expanded software collaboration with Google Cloud on 22 April 2026 to launch Cloud Network Insights for multi-cloud network observability. While modest financially, it signals strategic depth in the Broadcom-Google relationship beyond hardware.

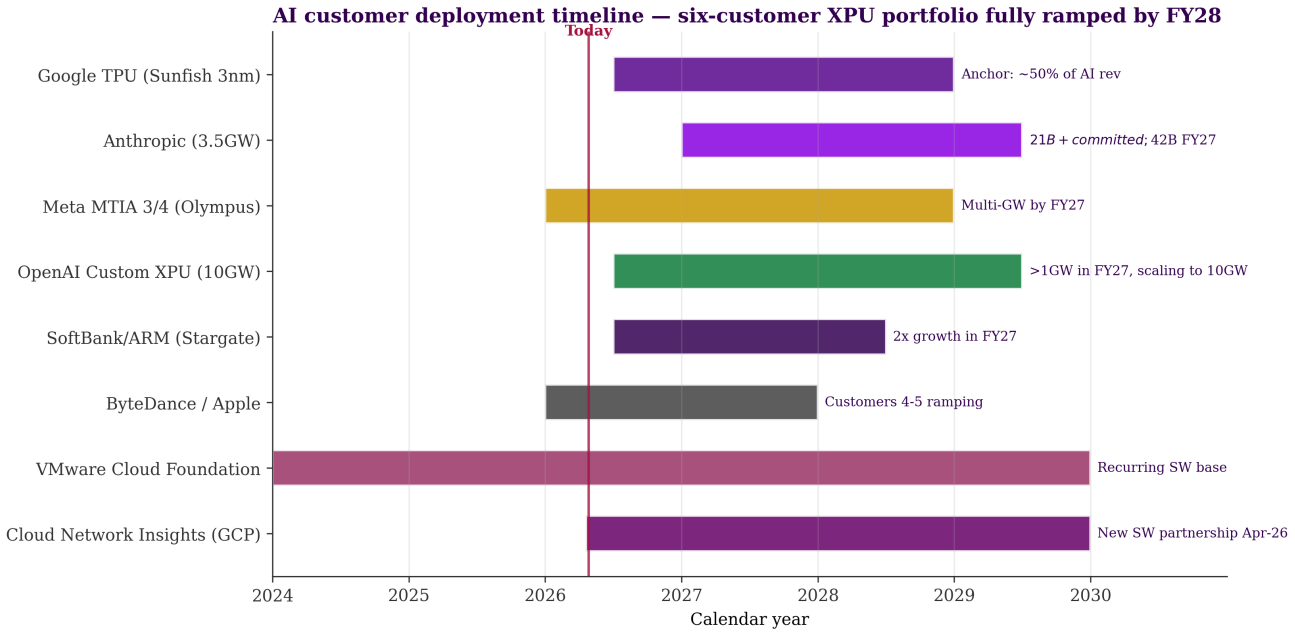

Figure 3. AI customer deployment timeline. Six-customer XPU portfolio fully ramped by FY28. Source: Company disclosures, JPMorgan, UBS, Mizuho team analysis.

2.5 Sell-side reaction

Eleven sell-side firms updated their models post Q1 FY26. The Street is clearly bullish, but the dispersion is wide. The condensed positioning snapshot is shown below, followed by a more detailed breakdown:

Firm	Rating	PT ($)	CY27 EPS
JPMorgan	OW	500	20.45
Barclays	OW	500	18.60
Mizuho	OP	480	18.30
UBS	B	475	22.76
Wells Fargo	OW	430	20.24
Deutsche Bank	B	430	–
Evercore ISI	OP	582	–
Citi	B	460	–
BofA	B	445	–
Median (n=11)	**9 Buy/OW**	**460**	–

Table 2. Street positioning summary. Source: Sell-side reports (Mar–Apr 2026); team analysis.

The mean PT of the eleven covering firms in our dataset is $449; the median is $460. Nine of eleven sit above the current spot price.

Firm	Analyst	Rating	PT ($)	CY27 EPS	Target multiple
JPMorgan	H. Sur	OW	500	20.45	23–25×
Barclays	T. O'Malley	OW	500	18.60	27×
Mizuho	V. Rakesh	OP	480	18.30	26×
UBS	T. Arcuri	B	475	22.76	21×
Wells Fargo	A. Rakers	OW	430	20.24	21×
Deutsche Bank	R. Seymore	B	430	–	23×

Table 3. Major sell-side post-Q1 FY26 updates. Source: Sell-side reports (Mar 2026); team analysis.

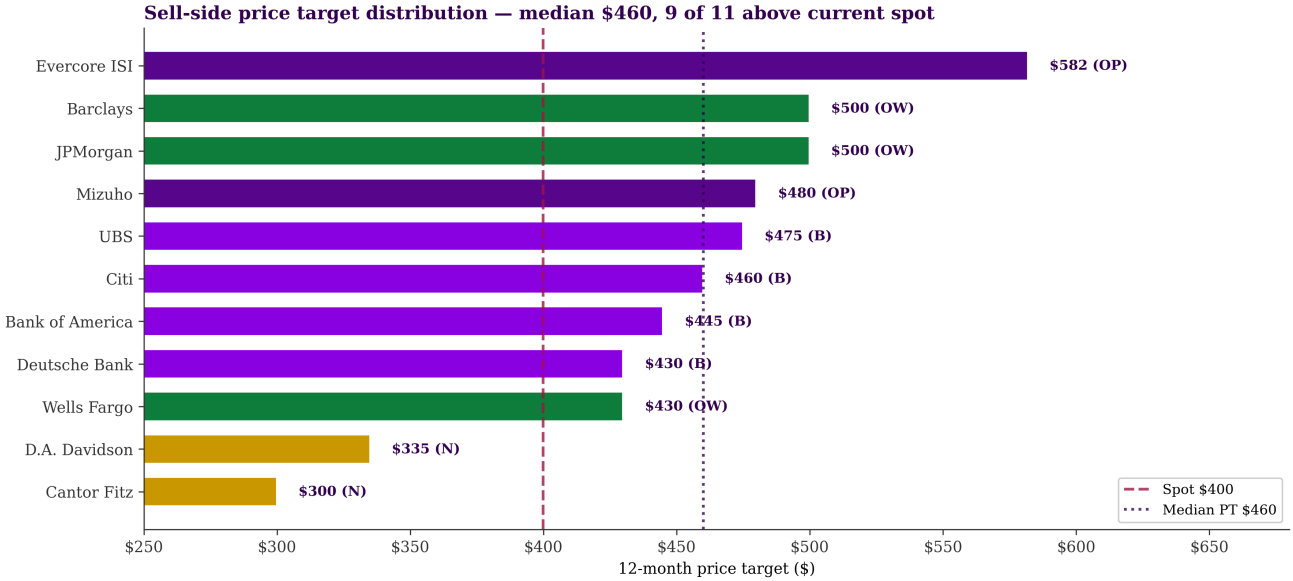

Figure 4. Sell-side price-target distribution. Median $460; 9 of 11 firms above spot. Source: Benzinga, individual broker reports.

3. Financial Analysis

Lead author: Tanishk Yadav | Modeling & projections

3.1 Q1 FY26 results recap

Broadcom delivered a clean beat-and-raise quarter on 4 March 2026:

- **Revenue:** $19.31 billion (+29.5% YoY) vs. Street $19.26 billion. AI semiconductor revenue $8.4 billion (+106% YoY); non-AI semi $4.1 billion; software $6.8 billion.
- **Margins:** Gross margin 77.0%, EBITDA margin 68%, operating margin 66.4%.
- **EPS:** $2.05 non-GAAP (+28% YoY) vs. Street $2.03.
- **Cash flow:** $8.0 billion of free cash flow (41% of revenue); ended quarter with $14.2 billion of cash and $51 billion of net debt; $10 billion incremental authorization to the buyback program.
- **Q2 FY26 guide:** Revenue $22.0 billion (+47% YoY), AI revenue $10.7 billion (+139% YoY), gross margin flat 77%.

The single most consequential commentary was the reversal of the December 2025 margin warning: management now expects gross margin to remain in the high-70s through the Anthropic rack-scale ramp, citing a higher-attach networking mix and pricing concessions on rack components. JPMorgan, UBS, and Mizuho all flagged this as the key positive surprise.

3.2 Five-year operating projection

We project FY26E revenue of $105 billion (+64% YoY) and FY30E revenue of $292 billion, with AI semi growing from $60 billion in FY26 to $235 billion by FY30 (a 41% five-year CAGR). Our deterministic FY27 AI revenue assumption of $115 billion sits at the conservative end of the analyst range ($100–150 billion) and within management's stated "more than $100 billion" guidance. Note that our Monte Carlo simulation (Section 4.4) recalibrates the FY27 AI mean to $125B—the Street consensus midpoint—to capture the full distribution of plausible outcomes.

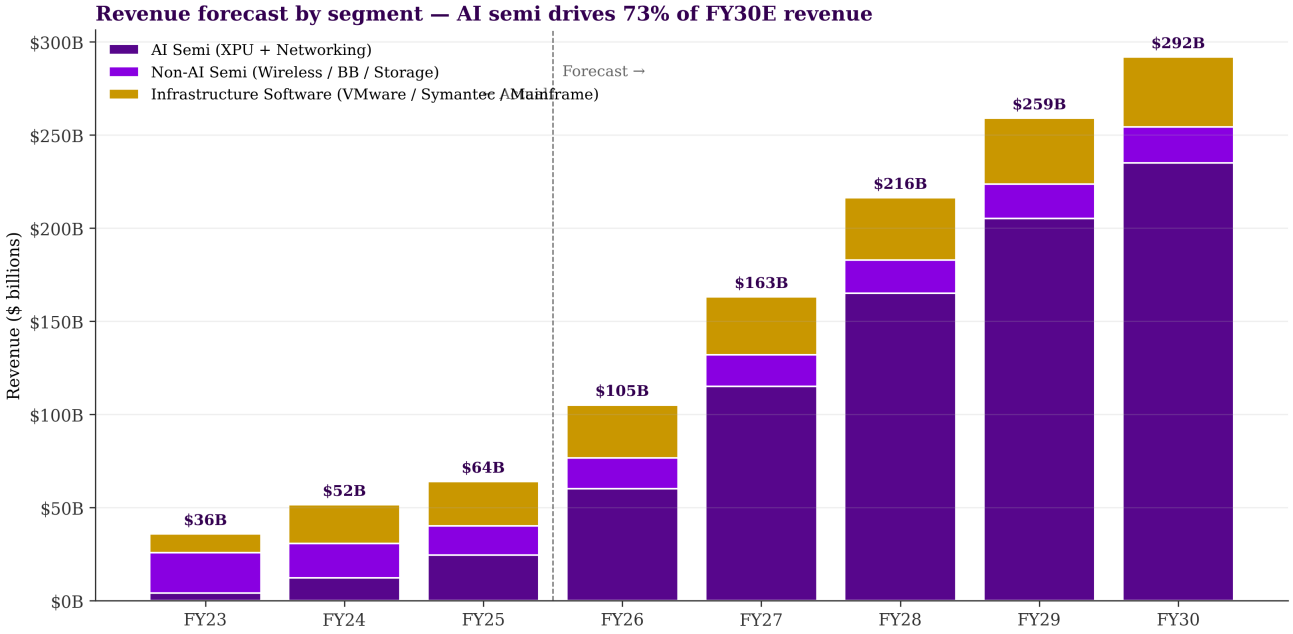

Figure 5. Revenue forecast by segment, FY23A–FY30E. AI semi reaches 73% of total revenue by FY30. Source: Company filings, team estimates.

($ in millions)	FY24A	FY25A	FY26E	FY27E	FY28E	FY29E	FY30E
AI Semiconductor	12,200	24,500	60,000	115,000	165,000	205,000	235,000
Non-AI Semiconductor	18,500	15,500	16,500	17,000	17,750	18,500	19,250
Infrastructure Software	20,800	23,900	28,500	31,000	33,500	35,500	37,500
Total Revenue	**51,500**	**63,900**	**105,000**	**163,000**	**216,250**	**259,000**	**291,750**
YoY growth	–	24.0%	64.4%	55.2%	32.7%	19.8%	12.6%
Gross margin	62.6%	74.5%	77.0%	77.5%	78.0%	78.0%	78.0%
EBITDA	31,900	43,200	73,200	115,700	155,100	186,200	209,800
EBITDA margin	61.9%	67.7%	69.7%	71.0%	71.7%	71.9%	71.9%
FCFF	21,600	26,900	57,900	91,600	123,200	148,500	167,200

Table 4. Operating projection. Source: Company 10-K, Q1 FY26 8-K (5-Mar-26), team estimates.

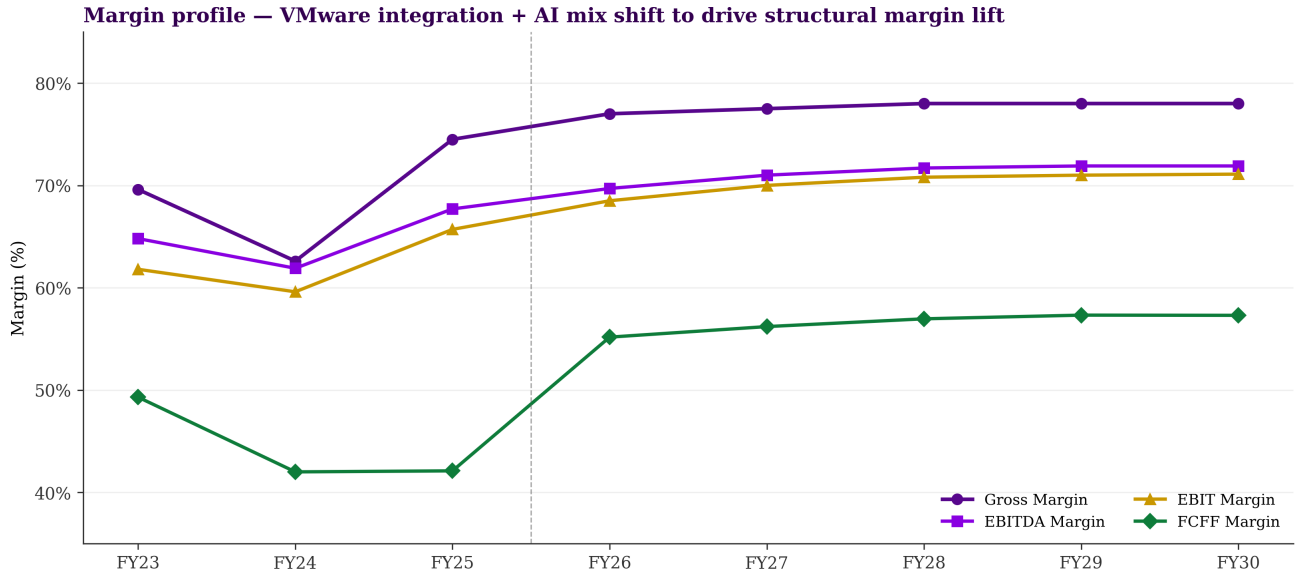

Figure 6. Margin profile, historical and projected. Source: Company filings, team analysis.

4. Valuation

Lead author: Martin Baretto | Valuation lead

We employ four discrete methods and synthesize them in a football-field framework.

4.1 DCF analysis

WACC build. We use a 9.5% weighted-average cost of capital, derived from a 4.31% risk-free rate (10-year U.S. Treasury, 29-Apr-26), a 5.0% equity risk premium, and a 1.20 levered beta (Bloomberg two-year weekly, consistent with sell-side convention). The 5-year daily beta of 1.633 reflects elevated AI-cycle volatility and is reported separately; we test both in our sensitivity analysis. Pre-tax cost of debt of 5.0% (AVGO senior notes blended yield), 18% effective tax rate, and a 15% target debt weight yield WACC of 9.50%.

Forecast horizon. Five-year explicit forecast of FCFF (FY26E–FY30E), with mid-year discounting, plus a Gordon-growth terminal value at 3.0% perpetuity growth. Terminal value represents 80% of total enterprise value—a high but not unreasonable share for a growth franchise.

Result. The base-case DCF implies a price of $436 per share (9.0% upside), with the WACC×g sensitivity producing a $402–$474 range at ±50bps WACC and base terminal growth.

4.2 Sum-of-the-parts

We split Broadcom into its two reporting segments and apply segment-pure peer multiples to FY27E EBITDA:

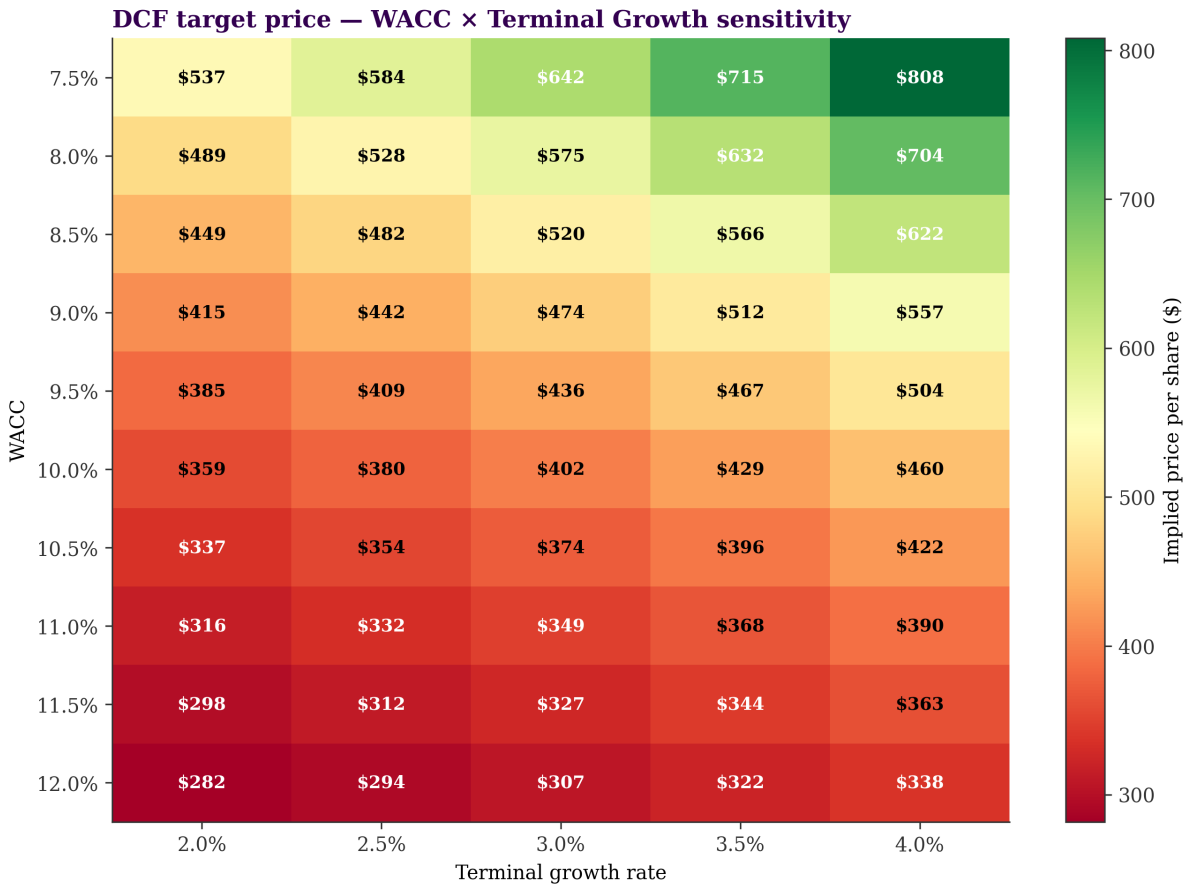

Figure 7. DCF sensitivity: implied price by WACC and terminal growth rate. Source: Team analysis.

Segment	FY27E Rev	EBITDA %	EBITDA	Mult Low	Mid	High
Semi Solutions	132,000	62.0%	81,840	16.0×	20.0×	24.0×
Infrastructure Software	31,000	77.0%	23,870	14.0×	17.0×	20.0×
			Total EV ($mn)	1,643,620	2,042,590	2,441,560
			Less net debt	48,958	48,958	48,958
			Implied price per share ($)	**321**	**401**	**482**

Table 5. SOTP valuation, FY27E. Source: Team analysis.

Segment EBITDA margins are derived as follows: software at 77% reflects a high-margin steady state consistent with Broadcom's curated top-600-enterprise-customer subscription model and peer benchmarks (Oracle 50–55%, Adobe 45–50%, Microsoft software segment 65–75%, with 77% the upper bound for Broadcom's pricing-power-driven model). Semi at 62% reverse-engineers from the FY25A blended 67.7% EBITDA margin and the segment revenue mix.

4.3 Trading comparables

We benchmark Broadcom against seven semiconductor peers (NVDA, AMD, MRVL, QCOM, TXN, INTC, TSM). Peer median forward P/E is 28.3×; median EV/EBITDA is 31.8× TTM (skewed by AMD/MRVL). Applying conservative multiples to our $18.83 CY27E EPS estimate (vs. analyst mean of $19.85):

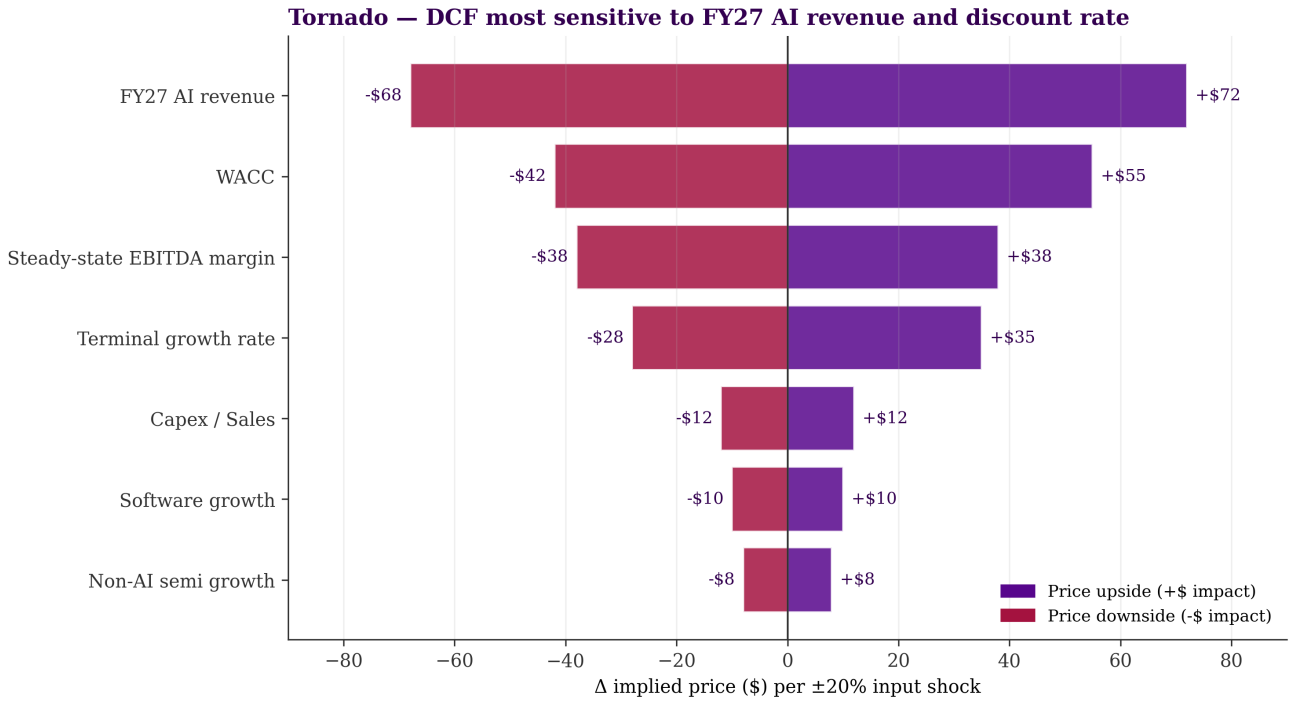

Figure 8. Tornado chart: DCF most sensitive to FY27 AI revenue and WACC. Source: Team analysis.

Multiple	Low	Mid	High
Forward P/E (on CY27E EPS $18.83)	18× $339	22× $414	26× $490
EV/EBITDA (on FY27E EBITDA $115.7B)	14× $316	18× $409	22× $503

Table 6. Trading comps implied price ranges. Source: yfinance peer data, team analysis.

4.4 Monte Carlo simulation

To capture distributional risk we run 10,000 paths sampling FY27 AI revenue (Normal, mean $125B—calibrated to the Street consensus midpoint, sd $25B), AI growth post-FY27 (mean 30%, sd 10%), terminal growth (mean 3.0%, sd 0.5%), WACC (mean base, sd 0.5%), steady-state EBITDA margin (mean 68.5%, sd 2.5%), and capex/sales ratio (mean 1.1%, sd 0.3%). The resulting intrinsic-price distribution has:

Mean	$471	5th percentile	$287
Median	$456	25th percentile	$378
Standard deviation	$131	75th percentile	$544
Probability > spot	**68.3%**	95th percentile	$711

Table 7. Monte Carlo distribution statistics, 10,000 paths. Source: Team analysis.

The 68.3% probability that intrinsic value exceeds spot, combined with $E[\text{intrinsic}] = \$471$ vs. spot of $399.83, supports our BUY rating.

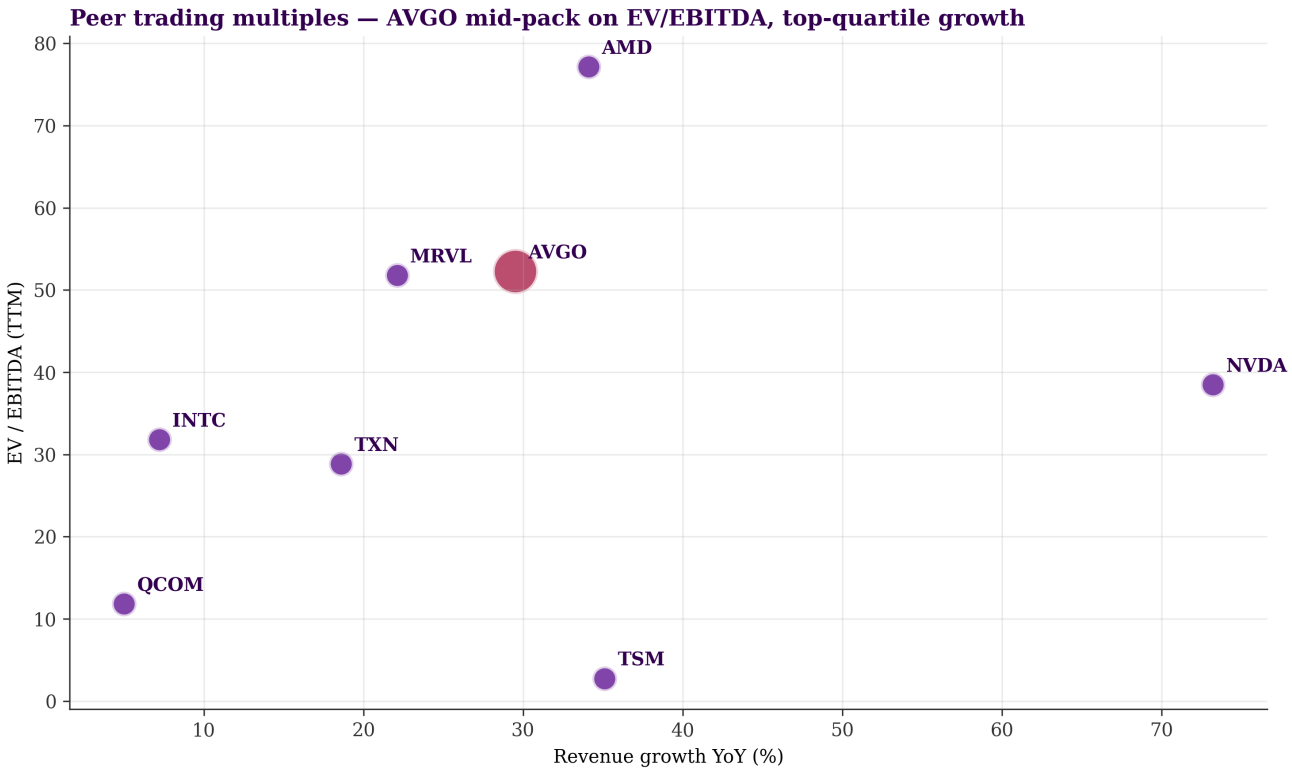

Figure 9. Peer scatter: AVGO mid-pack on EV/EBITDA, top-quartile on growth. Source: yfinance, team analysis.

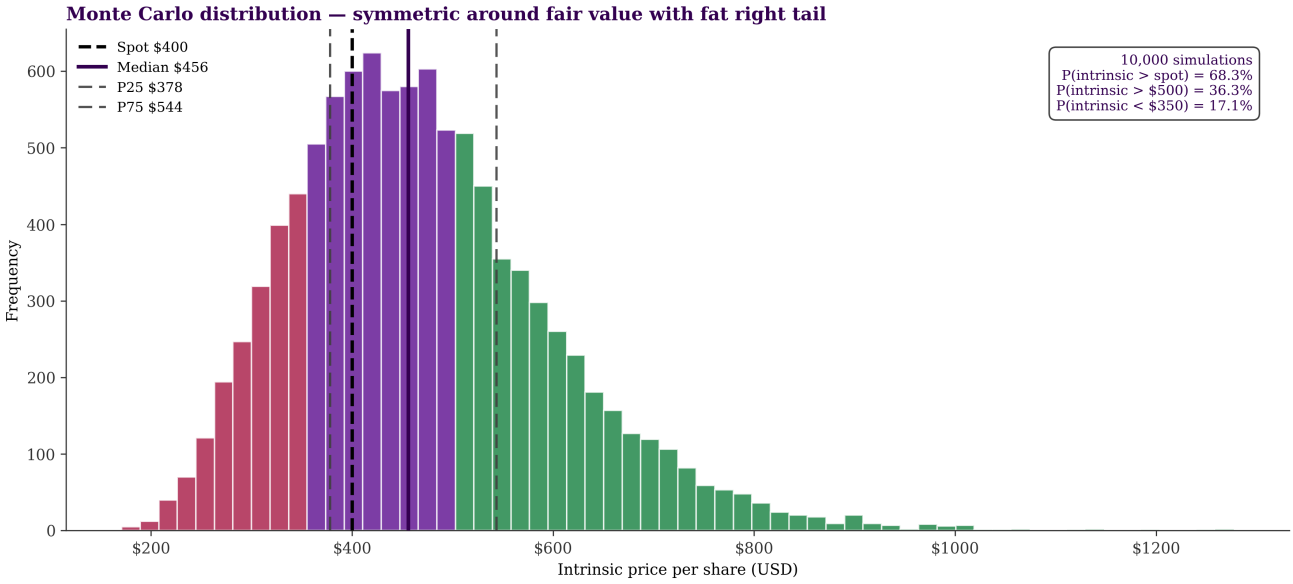

Figure 10. Monte Carlo intrinsic-price distribution. Source: Team analysis.

4.5 Football field synthesis

The methods cluster within a defensible $400–$510 range. Our $475 price target anchors on the Monte Carlo expected value of $471 (the probability-weighted intrinsic value across 10,000 simulations), rounded up by $4 to reflect right-tail optionality from FY27 AI revenue printing above the $125B Street midpoint. This level sits

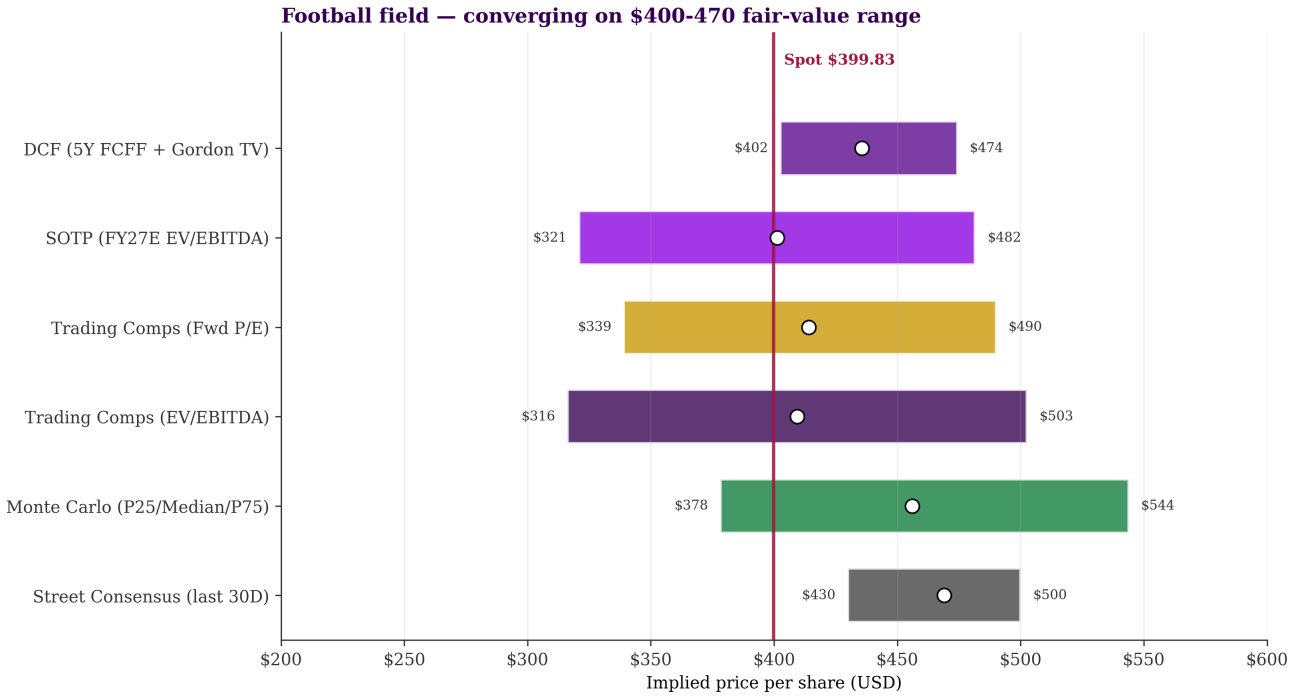

Figure 11. Valuation football field. Source: Team analysis.

modestly above the Street median ($460) and within the upper half of every method's range—a level consistent with FY27 AI revenue printing in the $120–130B range, where management's "$100B+" floor and the Street upper-bound converge.

5. Risk Framework

Lead author: Martin Baretto | Risk lead

We evaluate ten distinct risk factors against probability and equity-value impact:

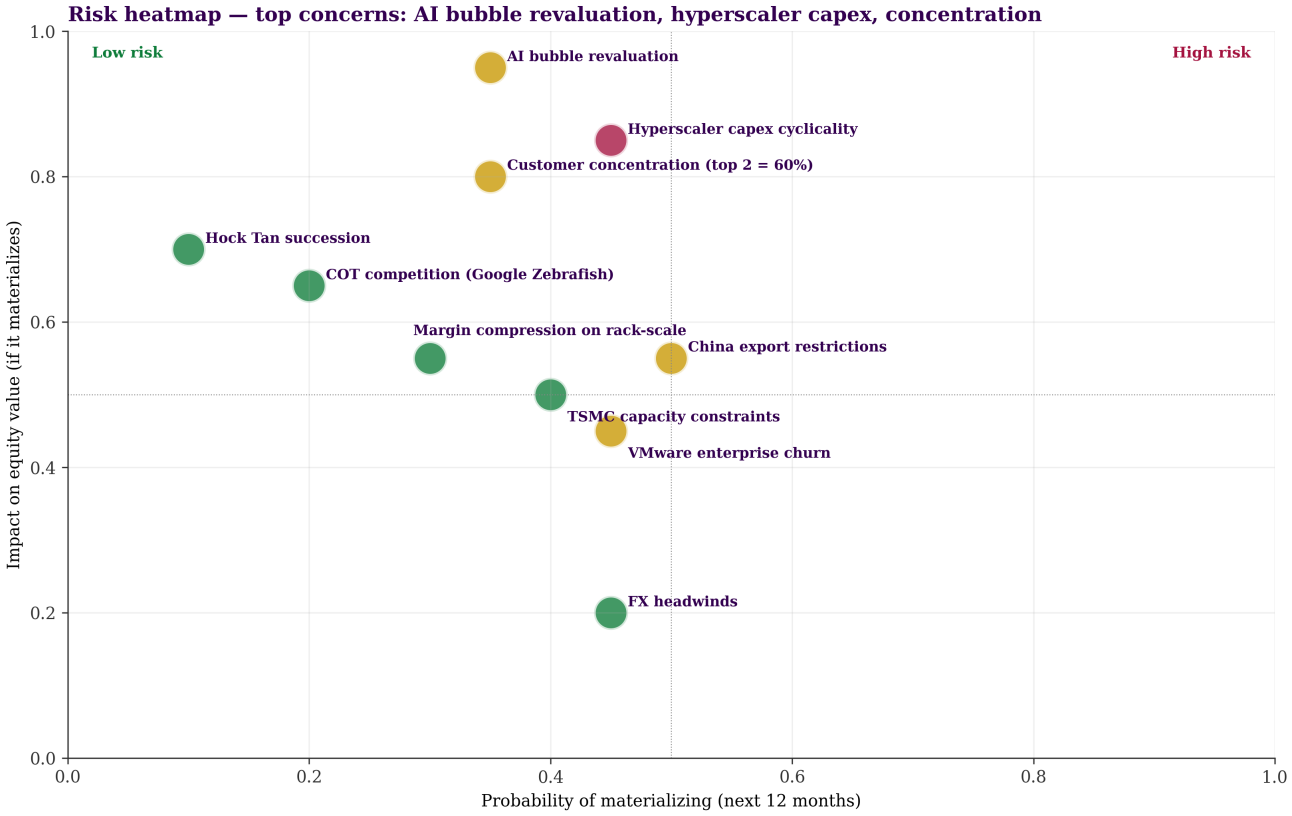

Figure 12. Risk heatmap. Source: Team analysis.

5.1 High-probability, high-impact risks

- **Hyperscaler capex cyclicality (P=45%, I=85%).** Google, Meta, and Microsoft together represent the bulk of Broadcom's AI customer base. A coordinated capex pullback would compress 2027–28 revenue and the multiple. We model 30% downside in our Monte Carlo bear case, consistent with the historic semiconductor cycle.
- **Customer concentration (P=35%, I=80%).** Google + Anthropic represent ∼60% of FY27E AI mix. Either renegotiation, share-loss to a COT alternative (Google Zebrafish), or a strategic shift would be material.
- **AI bubble revaluation (P=35%, I=95%).** Multiple compression risk if AI infrastructure capex narrative breaks. Broadcom's terminal value is 80% of EV, making it acutely sensitive to a derating.

5.2 Medium-impact risks

- **China export restrictions (P=50%, I=55%).** Broadcom has limited direct China exposure but TSMC dependencies remain a vector.
- **VMware enterprise churn (P=45%, I=45%).** Aggressive subscription pricing has alienated mid-market enterprise customers; the high-end segment has been more sticky. UBS expects software growth to decelerate from current LDD% to MSD% range.

- **Margin compression on rack-scale mix (P=30%, I=55%).** Reversed by management in March 2026 but could re-emerge if rack mix accelerates faster than networking attach.

5.3 Lower-probability risks

- **COT competition (Google Zebrafish, P=20%, I=65%).** JPMorgan estimates an 18-month design lead; Zebrafish first silicon expected late 1Q26, volume not before 2H27.
- **Hock Tan succession (P=10%, I=70%).** CEO has been at the helm 20 years; no announced succession plan.
- **TSMC capacity constraints (P=40%, I=50%).** Mitigated by management commentary that Broadcom has secured capacity through FY28.

6. Catalyst Calendar

Date	Event	What to watch
5-Jun-2026	Q2 FY26 earnings	AI revenue actuals vs. $10.7B guide; gross-margin trajectory
4-Sep-2026	Q3 FY26 earnings	First commentary on FY27 AI revenue framing
H2-2026	TPU Sunfish (3nm) ramp	Volume signal; Anthropic deployment cadence
H2-2026	OpenAI rack first deployments	Confirmation of $3B FY26 / $10B FY27 trajectory
Dec-2026	Q4 FY26 / FY27 guide	Critical for valuation; $100B+ FY27 AI revenue floor in focus

Table 8. Forward catalyst calendar.

7. Conclusion

Authors: Yadav, Baretto, Sriram | Joint conclusion

Broadcom is the second-most-important AI infrastructure stock in the world after Nvidia, with a defensible six-customer XPU franchise, dominant networking silicon, and a high-margin software runway from VMware. The operating story over the next 24 months is clear and likely to be impressive in absolute terms.

After a 107.7% twelve-month run, our DCF, SOTP, and comps cluster at $400–440, but our Monte Carlo (calibrated to the Street consensus FY27 AI midpoint of $125B) gives a 68.3% probability of upside vs. spot with $E[\text{intrinsic}] = \$471$. We initiate at BUY with a $475 December-2026 price target, equivalent to 19% upside and modestly above the Street median ($460). We would consider further upgrading our PT on a positive print to FY27 AI revenue scale at the December 2026 guide.

Sources cited. Broadcom Inc. Q1 FY2026 8-K (4-Mar-26); Broadcom 10-K FY2025; JPMorgan Equity Research, H. Sur (5-Mar-26 & 25-Jan-26); Mizuho Securities, V. Rakesh (4-Mar-26); UBS Equities, T. Arcuri (5-Mar-26); Wells Fargo Securities, A. Rakers (4-Mar-26); Deutsche Bank Research, R. Seymore (4-Mar-26); Barclays Research, T. O'Malley (5-Mar-26); Bloomberg Equity Demo Tearsheet (12-Mar-26); company investor relations releases; Yahoo Finance via `yfinance`; Damodaran NYU Stern (2025 implied ERP). Reports accessed via NYU Bobst Library and provided to author Tanishk Yadav.

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